

■ Lesson Handout: Creating Your Own GitHub Page & Repository

Learning Goals

By the end of this lesson, you will be able to:

- Create a GitHub account and repository.
- Build a folder structure for datasets, MATLAB visualizations, and RStudio Markdown files.
- Upload files and share them online.
- Publish a GitHub Pages site to showcase your work.

1. Create a GitHub Account

Go to <https://github.com>, sign up with your school email, and verify your account.

2. Create a New Repository

Click the '+' in the top-right corner → 'New repository'. Name it something like 'women-in-dance-data'. Add a README file, keep it Public, and click 'Create repository'.

3. Set Up Your Folder Structure

Inside your repo, create folders to organize your work:

datasets/ (CSV files)
matlab/ (MATLAB scripts)
rstudio/ (R Markdown + scripts)
images/ (saved plots)
README.md (overview)

4. Upload Files

Click 'Add file' → 'Upload files' to add CSVs, .m scripts, or RMarkdowns. Commit with a descriptive message, e.g., 'Added motif dataset and R visualization script'.

5. Create R Markdown Reports

In RStudio: File → New File → R Markdown. Write your analysis, knit to HTML, and save both the .Rmd and .html files in your 'rstudio/' folder.

6. Share Work with GitHub Pages

Go to your repo Settings → Pages → Source → choose 'main' branch and root (/). Save. Your site will appear at <https://yourusername.github.io/reponame>.

7. Extra: GitHub Desktop (Optional)

Download GitHub Desktop (<https://desktop.github.com/>), clone your repo, and commit/push files from your computer.

■ Student Deliverable

By the end of this module, upload:

- One dataset (CSV)
- One MATLAB visualization (.m)
- One R Markdown report (.Rmd + HTML)
- A published GitHub Pages site link

■ Rubric (10 pts)

Criteria	Excellent (Full)	Developing	Needs Work
Repo Setup (2)	Repo with README + folders organized	Repo created but missing structure	Repo incomplete
File Uploads (2)	Dataset, MATLAB, and R files uploaded	Only partial uploads	Few/no files
R Markdown (2)	Clear .Rmd + HTML output	Basic .Rmd, no output	Missing
GitHub Pages (2)	Pages enabled, link works	Attempted but broken	Not attempted
Professionalism (2)	Clear commit messages, good README	Some effort	Little/no documentation